

JOSEPH POINTER

AI Adoption Embedded in the Business | Fifteen Years in Regulated Financial Services

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PROFILE

Most AI programs stall at the moment someone has to change how they work. I spent fifteen years inside a regulated Fortune 100 making that change hold, with people who did not report to me, in a business where Risk, Compliance, and Legal could stop anything I built. I work from inside the team rather than from a central function. I find the work worth redesigning, build the thing, teach the people who will keep it running after I leave, then carry what worked to the next group. I build as well as enable. I direct a multi-agent practice daily and two products I conceived are live in production, so I know what an idea costs before I recommend it. I am not the engineer. I have built enough to know what I am asking for when I ask an engineer for it.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director, Business Management

February 2022 - July 2026

TIAA, Denver, CO. Fortune 100 financial services, \$1.5T AUM, fiduciary duty under ERISA and SEC oversight.

With TIAA since May 2011. Business Manager (2016-2022) | Senior Business Management Specialist (2013-2016) | Business Consultant (2011-2013)

Embedded With the Business, Across Seven Areas at Once

- **One adoption operating model carried across seven business areas, none of whose leaders reported to me.** I connected seven Client Services business areas through named liaisons, shared strategy, and peer learning, and moved each from pilot to a sustained way of working. Enablement, acceptable-use standards, and measurement ran from one place while every area kept ownership of its own use cases. I carried the working version forward instead of starting over in each area. The design was never the hard part. Getting seven leaders to give up their own version of the work was.
- **Built the champion layer so the work would not depend on me.** The named liaisons ran adoption in their own areas once I moved to the next one, and I coached them on prompting and on judging when AI was the wrong answer.
- **Did the reaching myself, one room at a time.** 16,000+ associates had access to the platform and I reached 1,500+ of them directly across 30+ town halls, team sessions, and one-on-one coaching. You cannot send an email and call it adoption.

From Use Case to Working Solution

- **Took an AI platform from an idea to a company-wide launch.** I conceived a 9-module AI-powered career development platform and led the team that built it, first for a major transformation population and then across the company. I owned use-case scoping and prioritization, phased rollout, governance, adoption strategy, and impact measurement.
- **Built the manager guide myself, in a week.** I built the platform's manager guide using Amazon Q Developer in one week, so the people asked to lead the change had something usable in front of them that week.
- **Reported results in numbers an executive could act on.** I defined the success measures, tracked them, and carried them to senior leaders through executive read-outs, business cases, and quarterly business reviews. Adoption was measured by active usage, never by headcount with access.
- **Learned the Microsoft estate from zero and ended up governing it.** I owned SharePoint governance across a 125-site estate and remediated 1,763 files flagged for PII with IT, which is where I learned that permission sprawl is a day-one AI exposure rather than a later phase.

Moving Safely Inside a Regulated Firm

- **Prototyped first, then set the hard limits.** I explored and prototyped first, then brought Risk, Compliance, and Legal in to set the limits once an idea was worth building. No client data or PII was allowed to be entered into the platform. No AI-initiated actions. Guided prompts that keep the person in control of every decision. Governance was a design input rather than a gate at the end.

- **Graded vendors when the money was real.** I held a seat on the corporate team that selected an enterprise platform, helping write the RFP and grading every proposal and finalist presentation. That was not an AI purchase and I do not present it as one. The evaluation discipline transfers to deciding which tool is worth the firm's time.

AGENTIC AI I CONCEIVED AND SHIPPED

- **A standing team of AI agents I operate daily.** Each agent has a defined role and a named gate, including an adversarial reviewer whose job is to attack the output before it ships. Before changing which model each agent runs on I wrote down what degradation would look like and set a revert-first rule, so the failure criteria existed before the change did. The gates have caught overclaims on their way into live work. They have also missed one. I published the methodology behind this practice on LinkedIn in 2026.
- **Two live products.** CareerPointers (careerpointers.org), where I conceived the journey, a four-agent AI interview simulator, and an applicant CRM, and directed the build. Future Me, Answered (futuremeanswered.com), where I designed the 5-stage framework, structured career data across 922 occupations, and developed most of the application by directing AI. Mike Pointer is co-founder and engineered the production backend, the databases and security that made them real.
- **I evaluate tools by building something in them.** A tool earns a recommendation from me after I have put real work through it, not after a demo.

Sales Engineer, Information Architect, Instructional Designer

January 2001 - March 2011

Interactive Media / FT Knowledge / Pearson Performance Solutions / Vangent Human Capital, Denver, CO.

- **Sat on the sales side of enterprise talent-technology deals for financial services clients.** I was the engineer on the sales team rather than the closer, scoping capability needs and shaping multi-year implementation plans for Bank of America, GE Capital, Royal Bank of Canada, Regions Bank, Unilever, and Verizon Wireless.
- **Designed a content model built to be reused.** I architected the Revolver LCMS content model, separating core content from contextual content so one source could publish many ways, deployed at five Fortune 500 enterprises. Writing something once so other people can adapt it is the same discipline as a reusable pattern library.

CAPABILITIES

AI Adoption and Enablement: Embedded Business-Unit Partnership | Use-Case Discovery and Prioritization | Pilot-to-Production Scaling | Adoption KPIs and Value Realization | Champion Networks and Communities of Practice | AI Fluency and Capability Building | Prompt Engineering Coaching | Business Process Redesign | Agentic and Multi-Agent LLM Workflows | Reusable Pattern and Playbook Documentation

Tooling: Claude | Microsoft 365 Copilot | Copilot Studio | Power Automate | Power Apps | SharePoint Governance | Microsoft Teams | ChatGPT | Amazon Q Developer | Kiro | Synthesia

Governance and Enterprise: Responsible AI Governance and Acceptable-Use Standards | Risk, Compliance and Legal Partnership | Permission and Access Exposure Review | Vendor Evaluation and RFP Scoring | Organizational Change Management | Executive Read-Outs and Quarterly Business Reviews | Leadership Without Line Authority | Regulated Financial Services (ERISA, SEC)

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

M.S. Instructional Technology, Bloomsburg University, PA (4.0 GPA) | B.A. Art, Millersville University, PA
Generative AI Leader Certification, Google (2026) | Lean for Financial Services, TIAA (inaugural class) | Leadership Skills, The Institute for Management Studies (2025)